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A GUIDE FOR HEALTH PRACTITIONERS

5 Website Mistakes *Costing Health Practitioners Clients*

The silent conversion killers on practice websites — and exactly how to fix them.

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INTRODUCTION

Your practice deserves a website *as good as your work.*

Most practitioner websites don't lose patients because the practitioner isn't good. They lose patients before the patient ever reads a word.

In the first five seconds. On a page that's a wall of text. On a services page that hides the price. On a button they can't find.

I know because I've been on both sides. I hold a Bachelor of Health Science in Naturopathy and I build websites for practitioners full-time. The patterns in this guide are what I see on almost every practice website I audit.

Fix these five things and you will book more consultations. That's the whole promise.

01

THE MISTAKE

Your homepage doesn't tell patients *who you help* in five seconds.

What it looks like

- Generic openers like "Welcome to XYZ Wellness"
- Soft-focus hero images of green leaves, pebbles, or hands holding tea
- Headlines about "holistic" care with no specific condition, patient, or outcome

Why it costs you patients

A patient searching *"naturopath for gut issues Brisbane"* needs to see the words **gut** and **Brisbane** on your homepage to trust they've landed in the right place. If they don't, they close the tab. The average visitor decides whether to stay on a page in under three seconds. You're competing with that attention span.

The fix

01 Replace your hero headline with a specific problem you solve or a specific patient you help.
"Functional medicine for women with chronic fatigue. Brisbane-based, Australia-wide via telehealth."

02 Put your suburb or service area in your hero or sub-headline.

03 Make your primary booking button visible without scrolling.

04 Remove any stock photography that could live on any other practitioner's site.

02

THE MISTAKE

Your site is a wall of text. *The eye has nowhere to land.*

What it looks like

- Long paragraphs with no breaks
- No sub-headings to guide the reader
- Every section looks like the last — same size, same weight, same colour
- Important information buried in the third paragraph of a wall-of-text bio

Why it costs you patients

Most website visitors don't read. They scan. If your page doesn't have clear visual hierarchy — headlines, sub-heads, bullet points, bolded takeaways — a patient with any time pressure will bounce before they find the thing they came for.

This matters even more for the patients you serve. Chronic illness, burnout, fatigue — they have less bandwidth for word vomit. Your site's job is to make the answer obvious.

The fix

01 Break every section into three things: a headline, one or two sentences of context, and a clear next step.

02 Use sub-headings every 100–150 words so the eye has somewhere to rest.

03 Turn any list of three or more items into actual bullet points.

04 Bold the single most important phrase in each paragraph.

05 Add white space between sections — patients need room to breathe as much as they need information.

03

THE MISTAKE

Your services page is vague. *No one knows what things cost.*

What it looks like

- "Book a consultation to discuss pricing"
- Service descriptions that say *what* you do but not *how long, how much,* or *what's included*
- No mention of health fund rebates, telehealth options, or package deals
- A list of modalities with no patient-facing context

> THE COST OF HIDDEN PRICING
>
> *Patients who have to email to ask the price don't email. They go to the next practitioner whose website tells them.*

Why it costs you patients

When a patient can see **"90-minute initial consultation, $220, rebate eligible, in-person or telehealth,"** they have every piece of information they need to say yes. When they can't, they say *"I'll look into it later."* Which usually means never.

The fix

01 List every service with its actual price — even if it's a "from $X" range.

02 For each service, state: duration, format, what's included, and what happens after.

03 Display rebate logos (HICAPS, Medibank, BUPA) near the booking CTA.

04 Include a "What to expect in your first consultation" section — format, prep, follow-up.

05 If you offer packages, show them clearly. Don't force patients to book a call to find out.

04

THE MISTAKE

No clear call-to-action. *Nothing for the patient to do next.*

What it looks like

- A "Contact" link in the nav, and nothing else
- Booking link tucked into footer text
- No email list, no free guide, no way to capture interest from patients who aren't ready yet
- A homepage that ends in "Thank you for visiting" instead of pointing to the next action

Why it costs you patients

Every visitor is at a different stage of readiness. Maybe 5% are ready to book today. Another 20% are curious. The other 75% are researching, comparing, thinking about it.
If the only option on your website is **"book a consultation,"** you capture 5% of visitors and lose the rest forever. A lead magnet — a free guide, checklist, or resource — captures the email addresses of the other 75%. Then you can nurture them into patients over weeks or months instead of hoping they remember you.

The fix

01 **Primary CTA:** Book a consultation. Visible in the nav, in the hero, and repeated at least three times on the homepage.

02 **Secondary CTA:** A lead magnet for your ideal patient.
Examples: Gut Health Starter Guide · 3-Day Energy Reset Meal Plan · What to Eat When You're Burnt Out.

03 Every page should end with a clear next step — not "thanks for reading."

04 Connect your lead magnet to an email platform so new subscribers get nurtured automatically.

05 Ask of every page:
"If this is the only page a patient sees, what do I want them to do next?"

05

THE MISTAKE

You're speaking clinical language *when patients search in plain English.*

What it looks like

- "Specialising in HPA-axis dysregulation and mitochondrial support"
- "Evidence-based functional medicine for complex chronic presentations"
- Service pages full of modality names, not patient problems
- Service titles like "Iridology" instead of "Find the root cause of your fatigue"

Why it costs you patients

Patients don't search for *"HPA-axis dysregulation."* They search *"always tired for no reason."* Google's algorithm matches search intent to page content — if your page doesn't contain the words real patients type, you don't appear in the results.

Even when they do land, patients don't recognise their own problem in clinical terminology. They came looking for someone who understands their fatigue, their bloating, their anxiety. If your copy reads like a peer-reviewed paper, they assume you're not talking to them.

The fix

01 Write a list of the top 10 things patients actually say when they book.
"I'm tired all the time." · "My gut feels off." · "My hormones are out of whack." · "I can't sleep."

02 Rewrite your homepage and services pages using those phrases first — clinical terminology second, as the
how I treat it
.

03 Create service pages for patient problems, not modalities. **"Fatigue"** beats **"Functional Medicine"** for SEO and conversion.

04 Keep your About page professional and clinical — that's where your credentials belong. Everywhere else, write for patients.

YOUR NEXT STEP

So — *what now?*

If you read these and felt your stomach drop a little, that's normal. Most practitioner websites have at least three of these mistakes. Some have all five.

OPTION 01

Fix it yourself.

Everything in this guide is doable on your own. It'll take you a weekend per mistake if you're capable on the tech side. Right path if you have the time, confidence, and design instinct to pull it off.

OPTION 02 · RECOMMENDED

Book a free 30-minute strategy call.

I'll audit your current site against these five mistakes — plus a few more I didn't include — and tell you exactly what would move the needle for your practice. No pitch. No pressure.

Book my strategy call →

AND ONE MORE THING

Need help building your own lead magnet and email funnel?

Mistake 04 is the exact problem most practitioners struggle with — because nobody teaches you how to build a lead magnet, connect it to an email platform, and nurture subscribers into patients. That's literally what we do. Ask about it on our strategy call.

ABOUT THE AGENCY

Make It Media is an Australian agency built *specifically for health practitioners.*

Founded by Kate, who holds a Bachelor of Health Science in Naturopathy, Make It Media builds practice websites for naturopaths, nutritionists, and integrative practitioners across Australia.

The difference: the person building your site understands the patient relationship, the clinical language, and how practitioners get booked — because she trained for it.

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